Draw a wireframe in Draw.io

Digital Technologies · School and personal computers

You will

- make a `wireframe.drawio.png` file in your project
- draw a labelled box for each part of your page, and a box with an X for each photo
- check your wireframe opens as a picture, ready for your template

You need

- VS Code with your project folder open (see the guide Open a project folder in VS Code)
- Draw.io Integration installed (see the guide Install VS Code extensions)
- your paper wireframe, if you drew one first

Before you start

- A wireframe shows where each part of a page goes, using boxes and labels. Colours and real photos come later.
- A `.drawio.png` file is a drawing and a picture at once: VS Code opens it in Draw.io, and everything else opens it as a picture.

 Click here  Look here

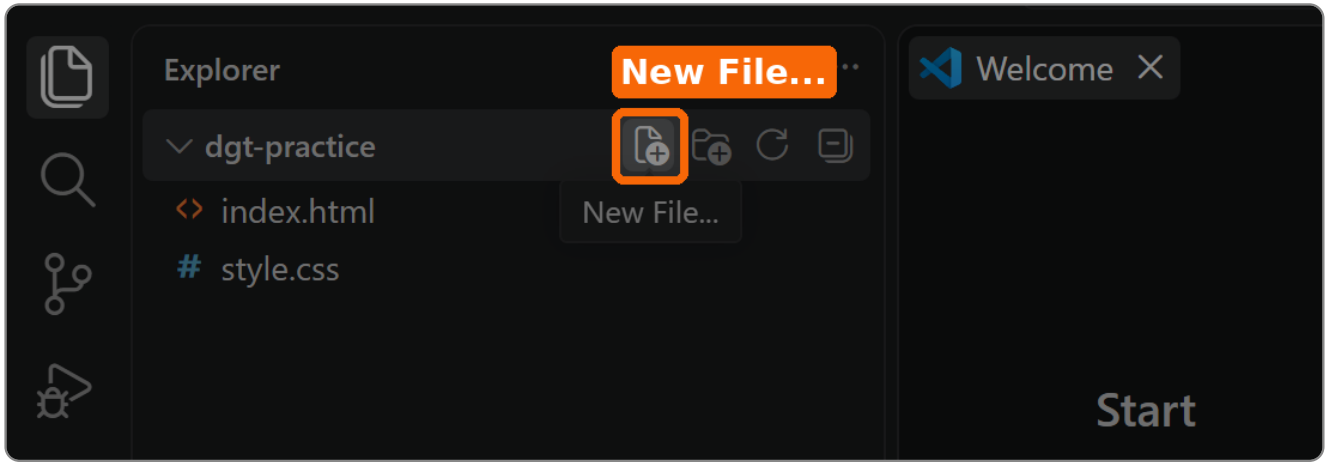
1

VS Code › Explorer

Click the **New File...** icon.

Type `wireframe.drawio.png`, then press `Enter`.

The name must end in `.drawio.png`.

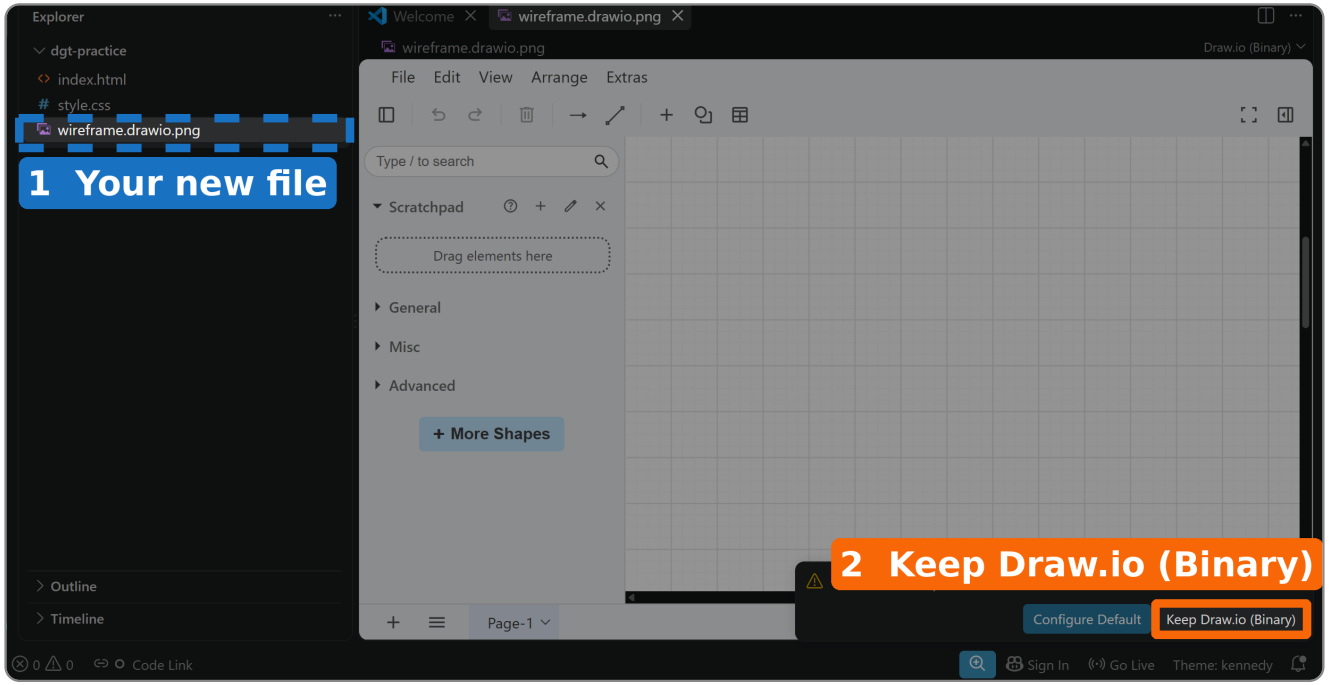


2

VS Code › wireframe.drawio.png

Wait while the Draw.io editor opens in a new tab.

If a message asks about default editors, click **Keep Draw.io (Binary)**.



> **Check:** the Draw.io editor, with shapes on the left and a grid on the right.

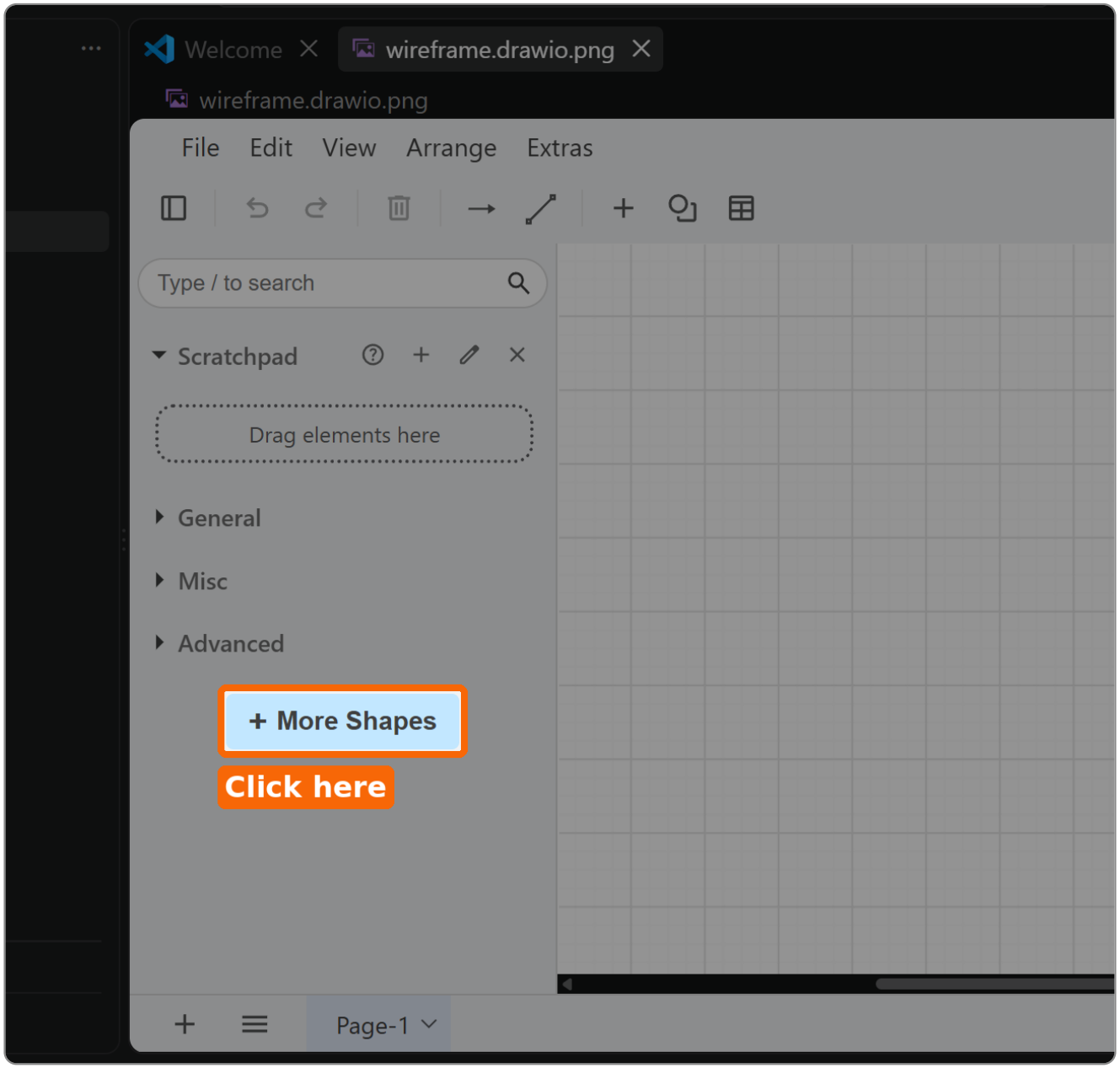
If something goes wrong
It opens as an image: install Draw.io Integration (see the guide Install VS Code extensions), then click the file again.

3

Draw.io › Shapes

Click **+ More Shapes** at the bottom of the shapes.

Mockups are shapes for drawing web pages and apps.



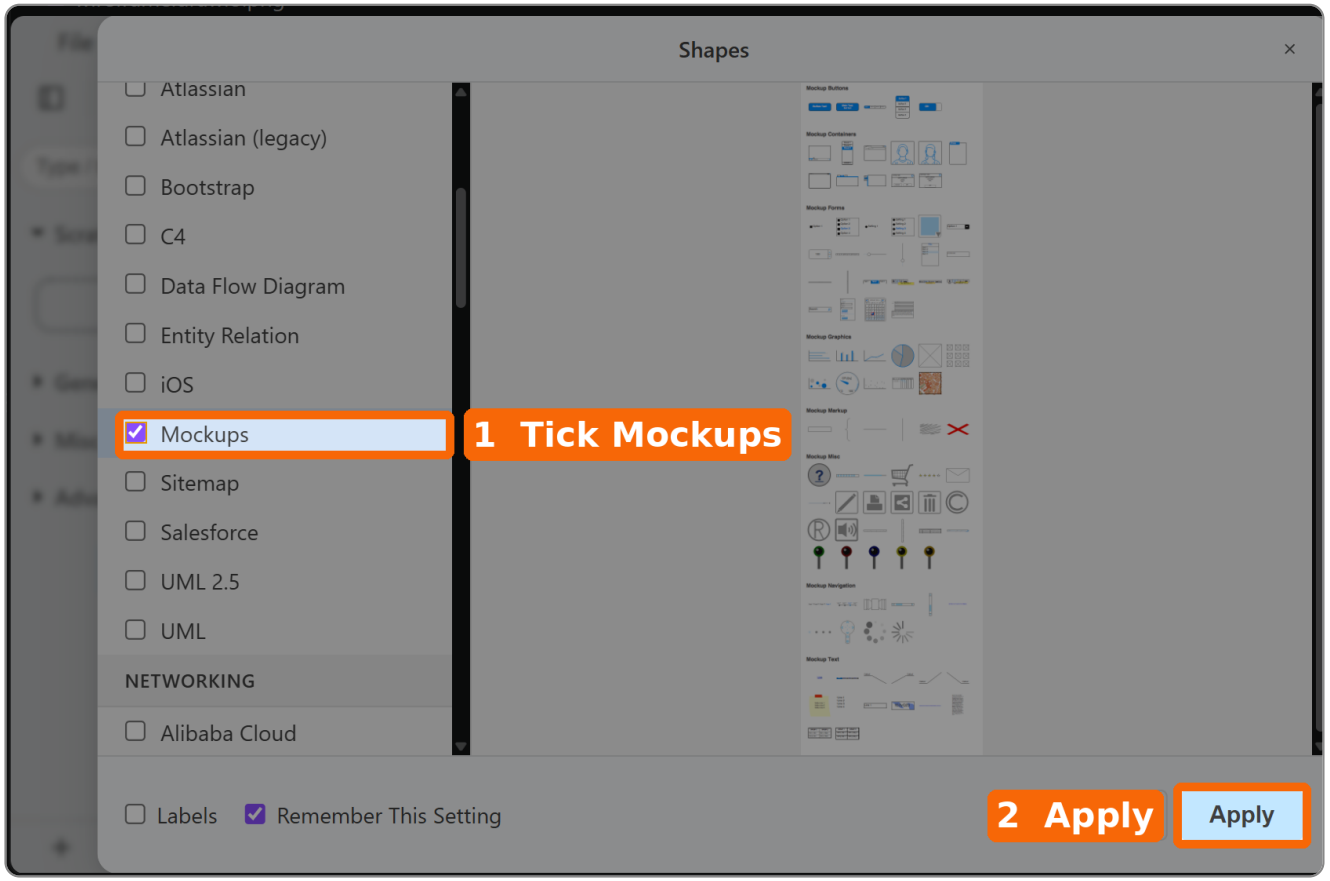
4

Draw.io › Shapes window

Tick **Mockups**.

Click **Apply**.

Leave **Remember This Setting** ticked, so the mockup shapes are there next time.



5

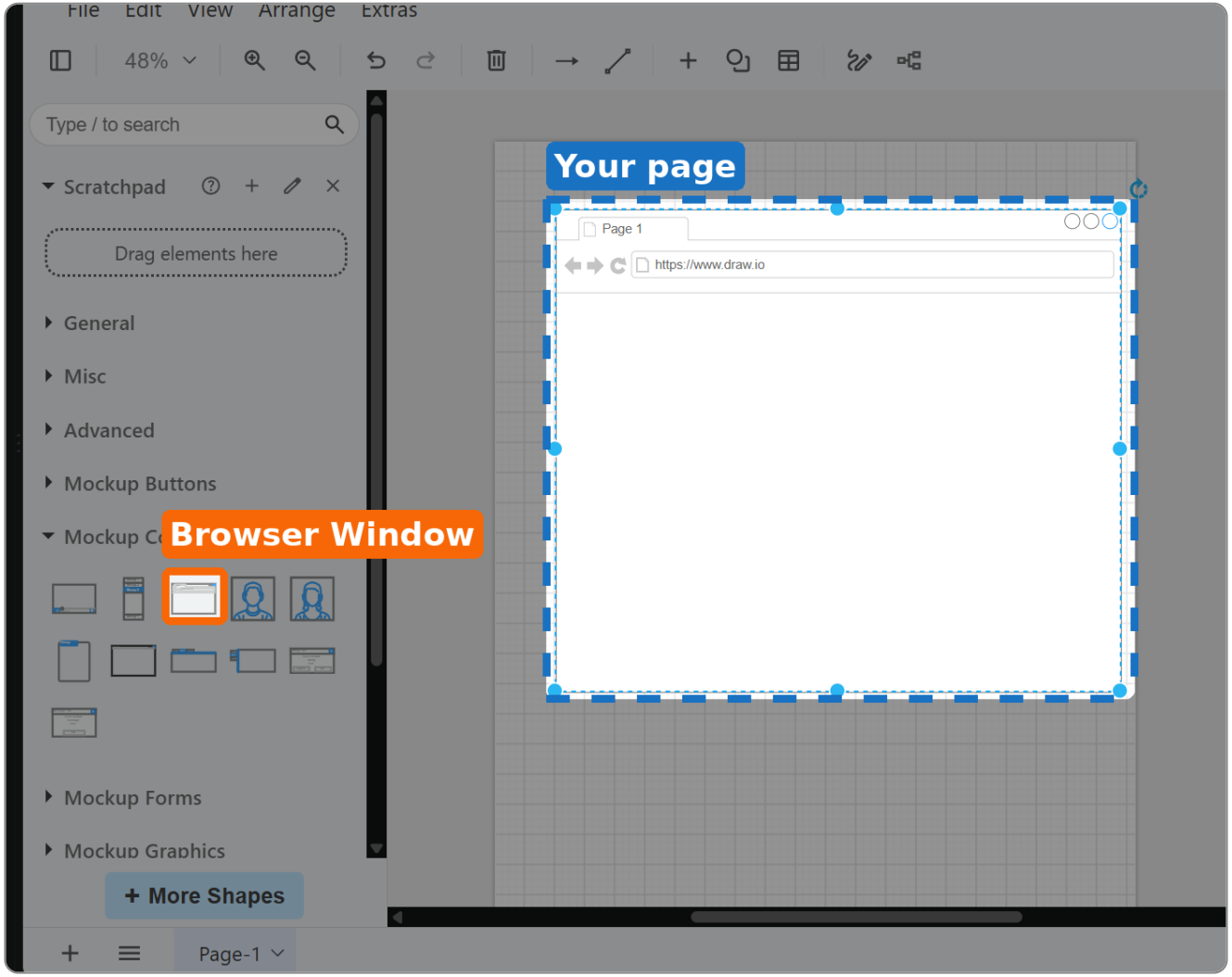
Draw.io › Mockup Containers

Click **Mockup Containers** to open it.

Click **Browser Window**, the third shape.

This is your page. Every other box goes inside it. Drag its bottom handle down to make it taller.

> **Check:** a browser window on the grid.



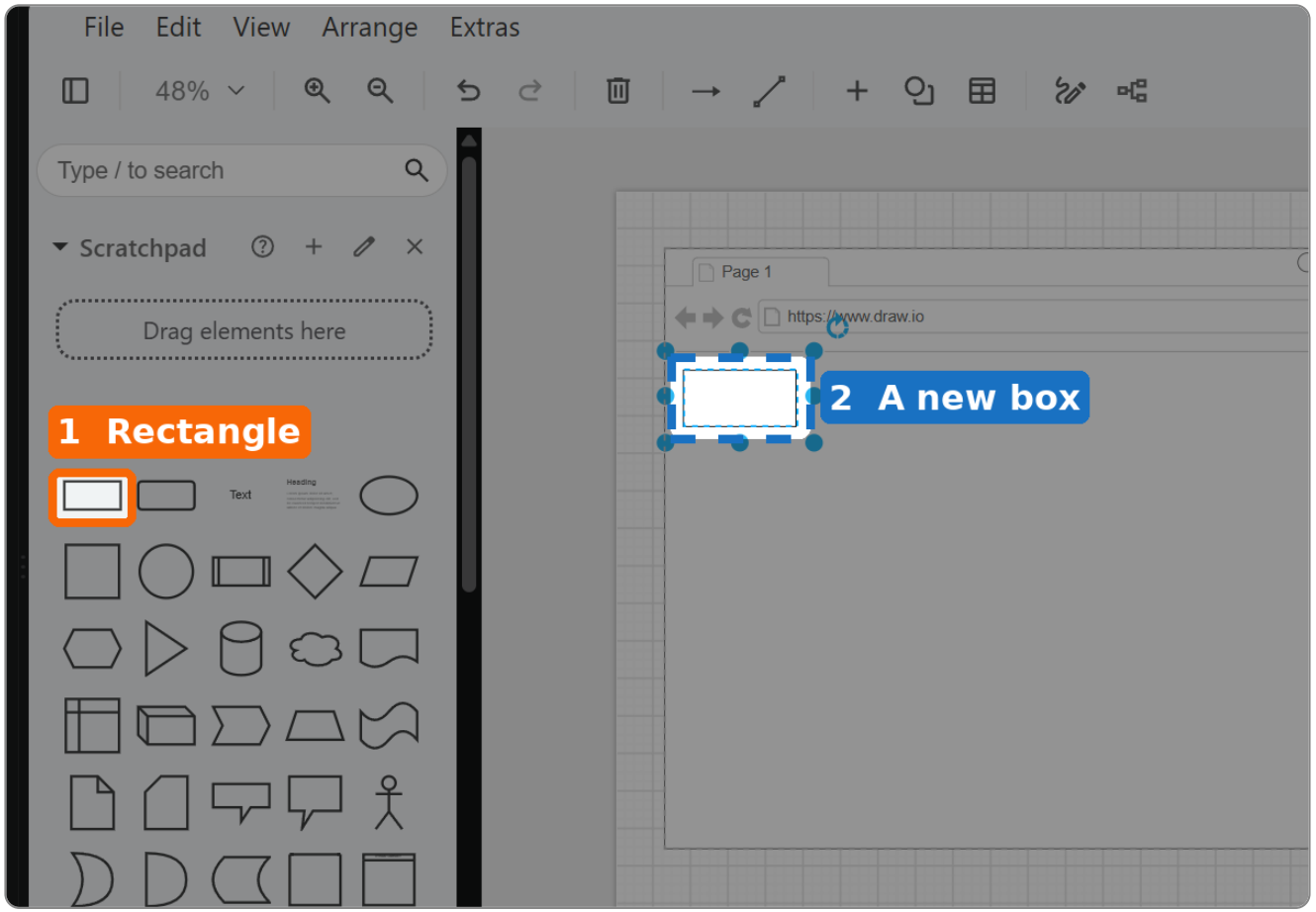
6

Draw.io › General

Click **General** to open it.

Click **Rectangle**, the first shape.

> **Check:** a small box inside your page.

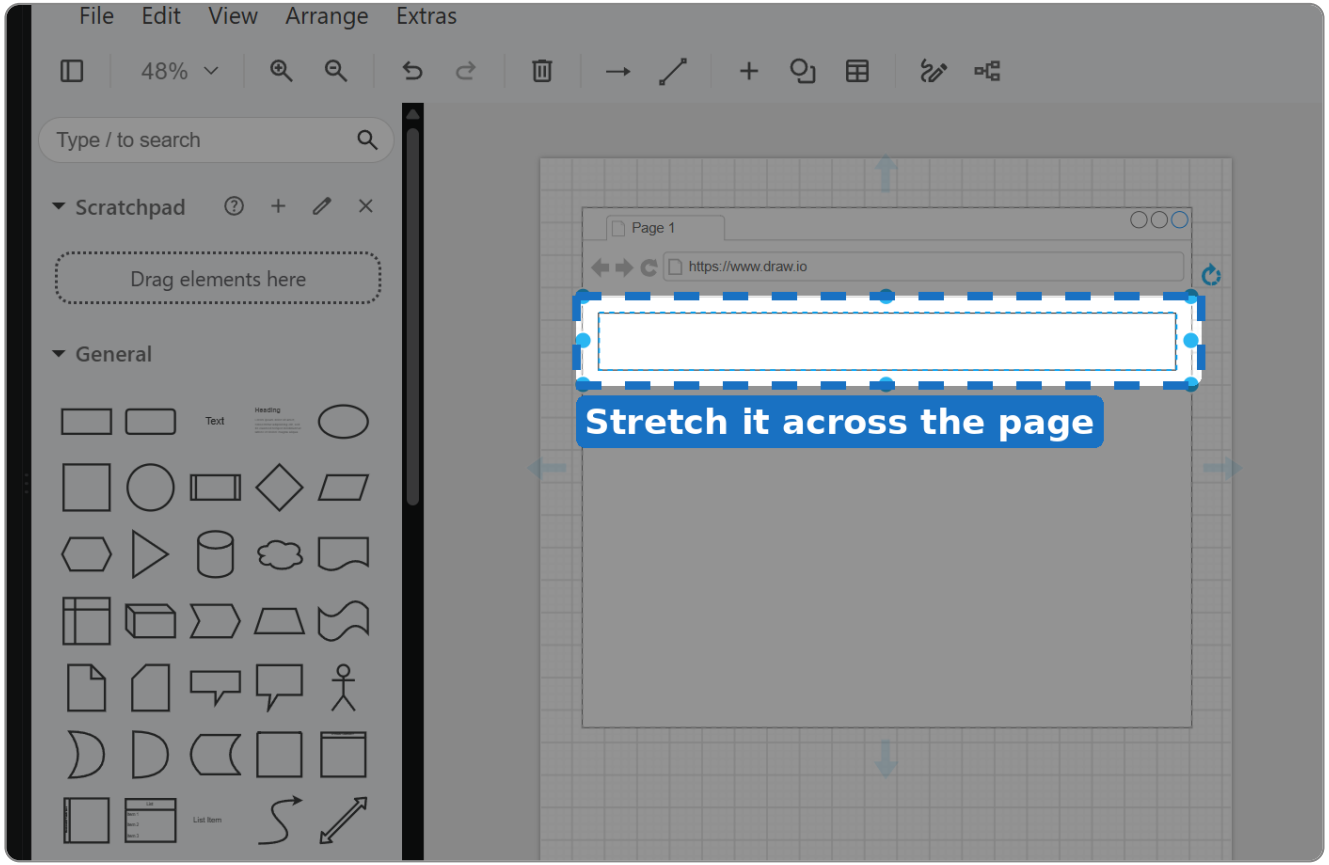


7

Draw.io › your page

Drag the box's side handles to stretch it across the page, under the address bar.

Blue lines appear when a box lines up with another. Use them to keep your boxes straight.



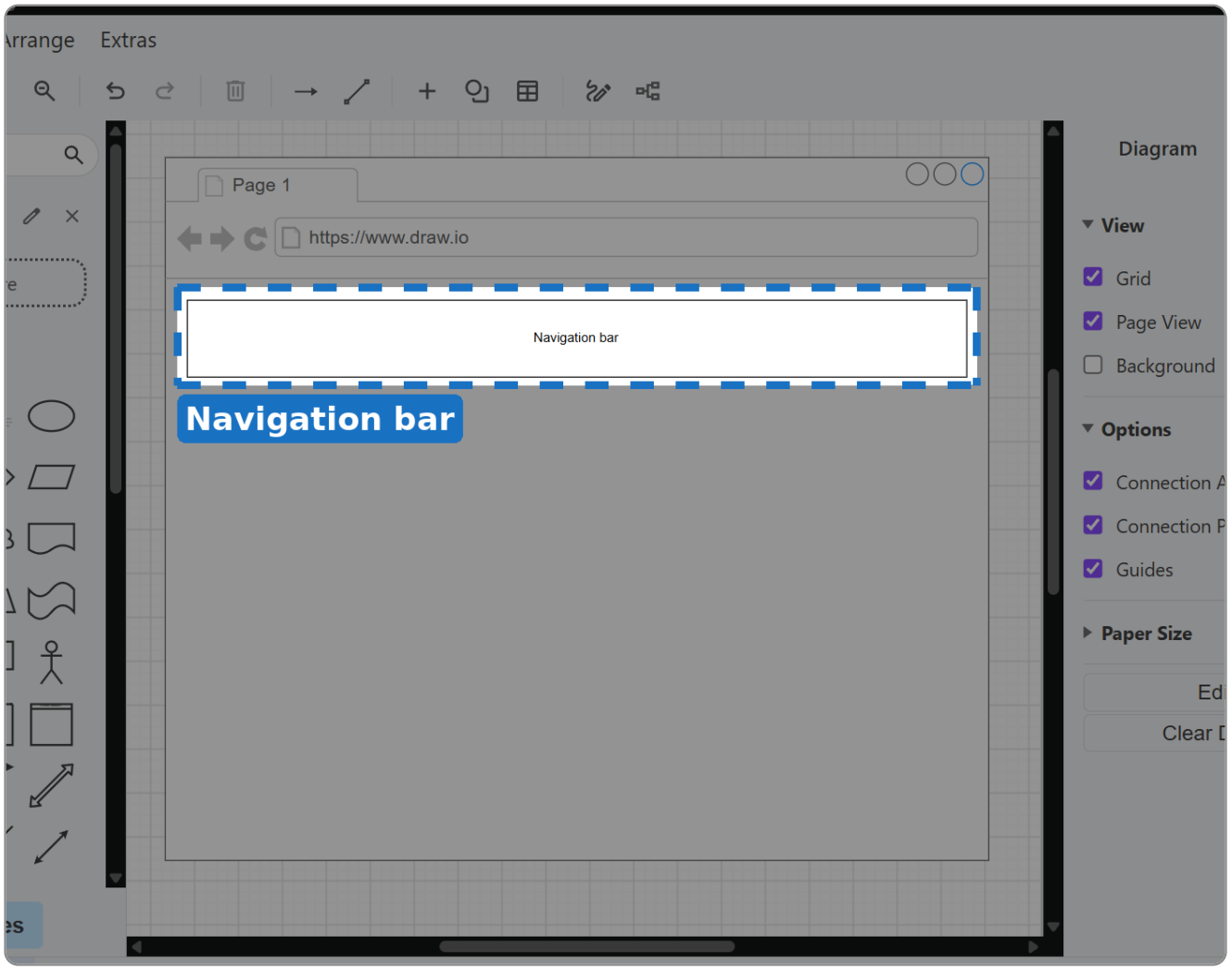
8

Draw.io › your page

Double-click the box.

Type `Navigation bar`.

Click an empty part of the page.



9

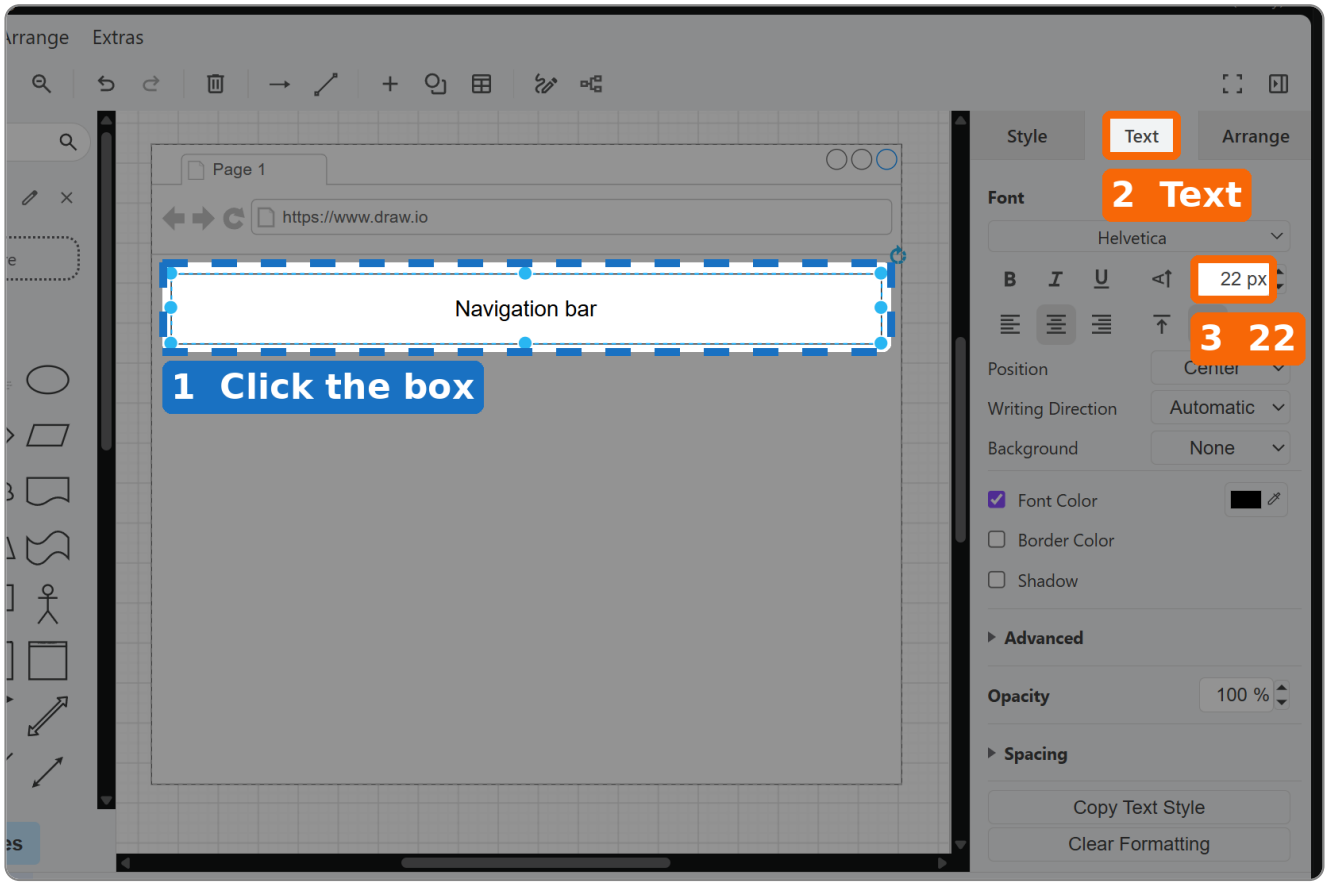
Draw.io › Text

Click the box.

Click the **Text** tab on the right.

Change the size to `22`, then press `Enter`.

Bigger words are easier to read once the wireframe is in your template.



10

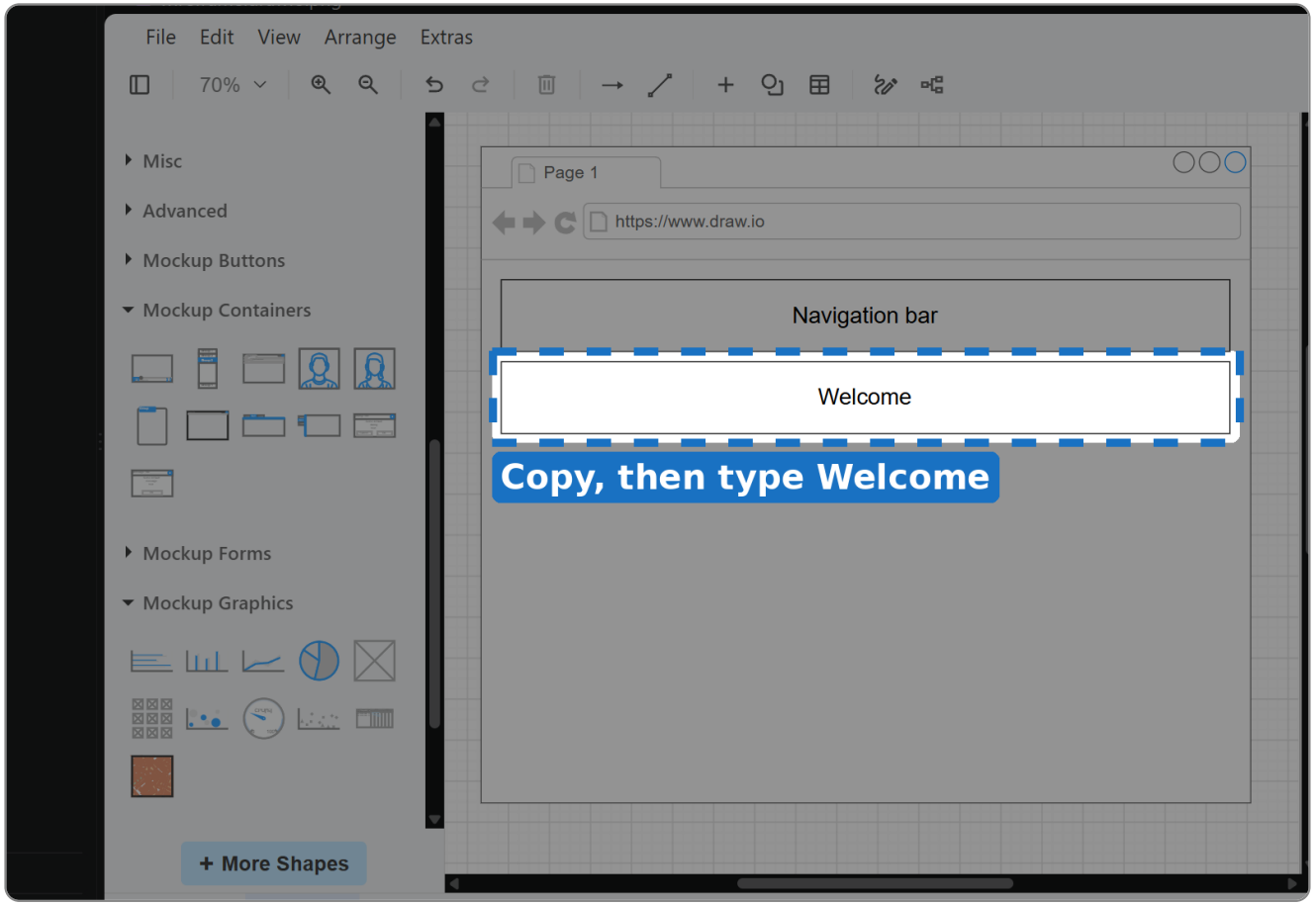
Draw.io › your page

Click the Navigation bar box.

Press `Ctrl` + `D` to copy it.

Drag the copy under it.

Double-click the copy and type `Welcome`.



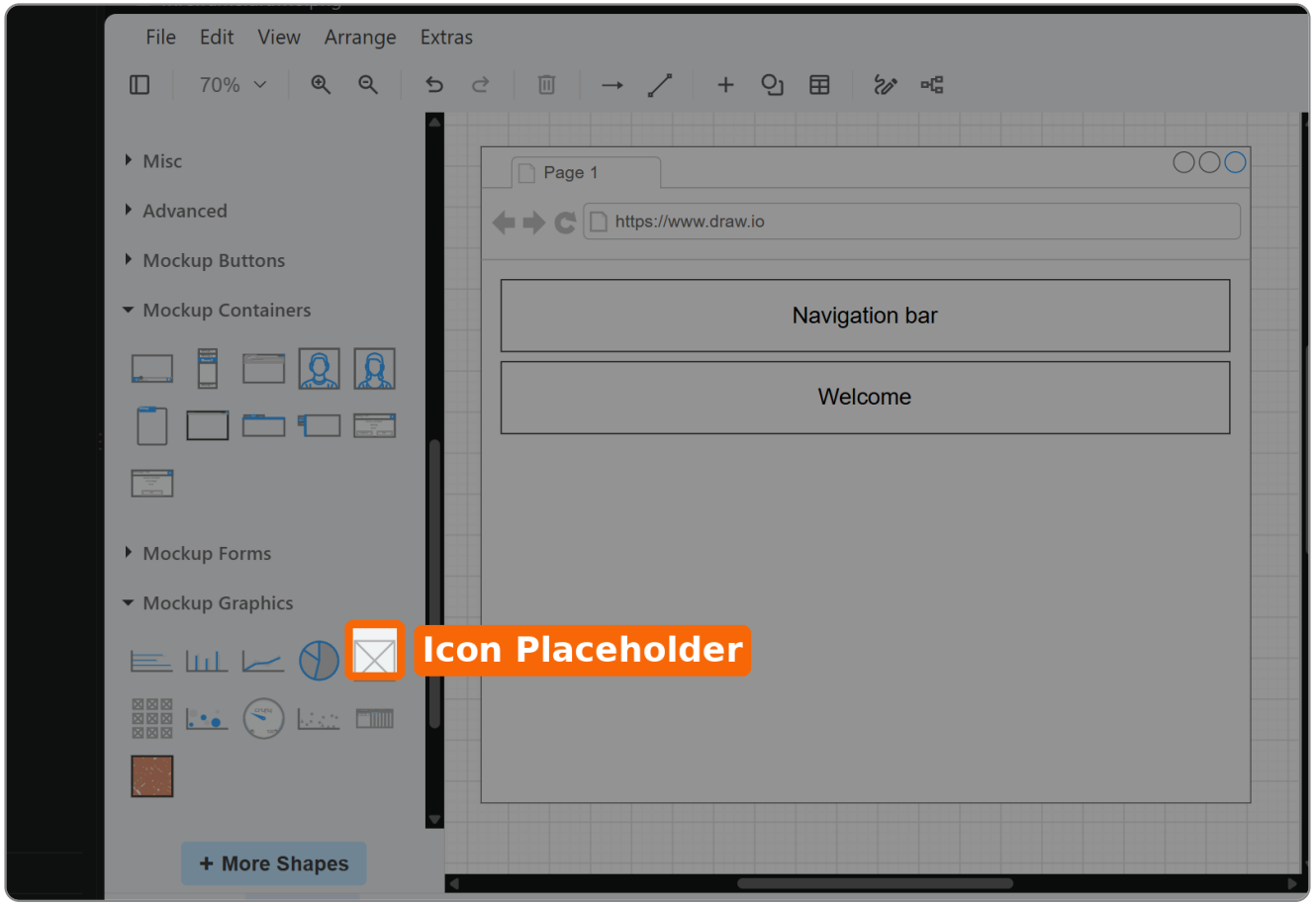
11

Draw.io › Mockup Graphics

Click **Mockup Graphics** to open it.

Click **Icon Placeholder**, the box with an X.

A box with an X means a photo goes here.

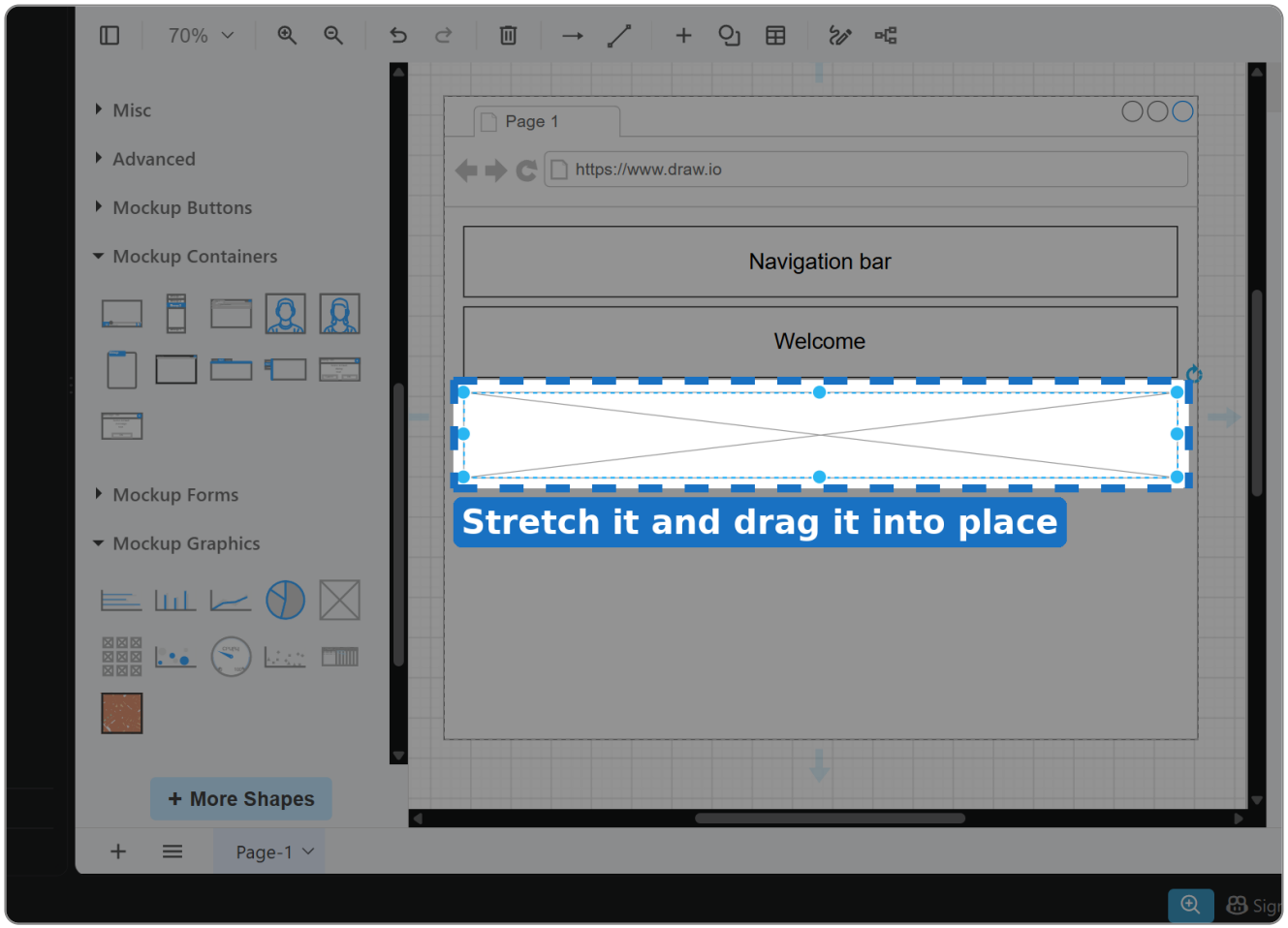


12

Draw.io › your page

Drag the handles to make it the size of your photo.

Drag it to where the photo goes.



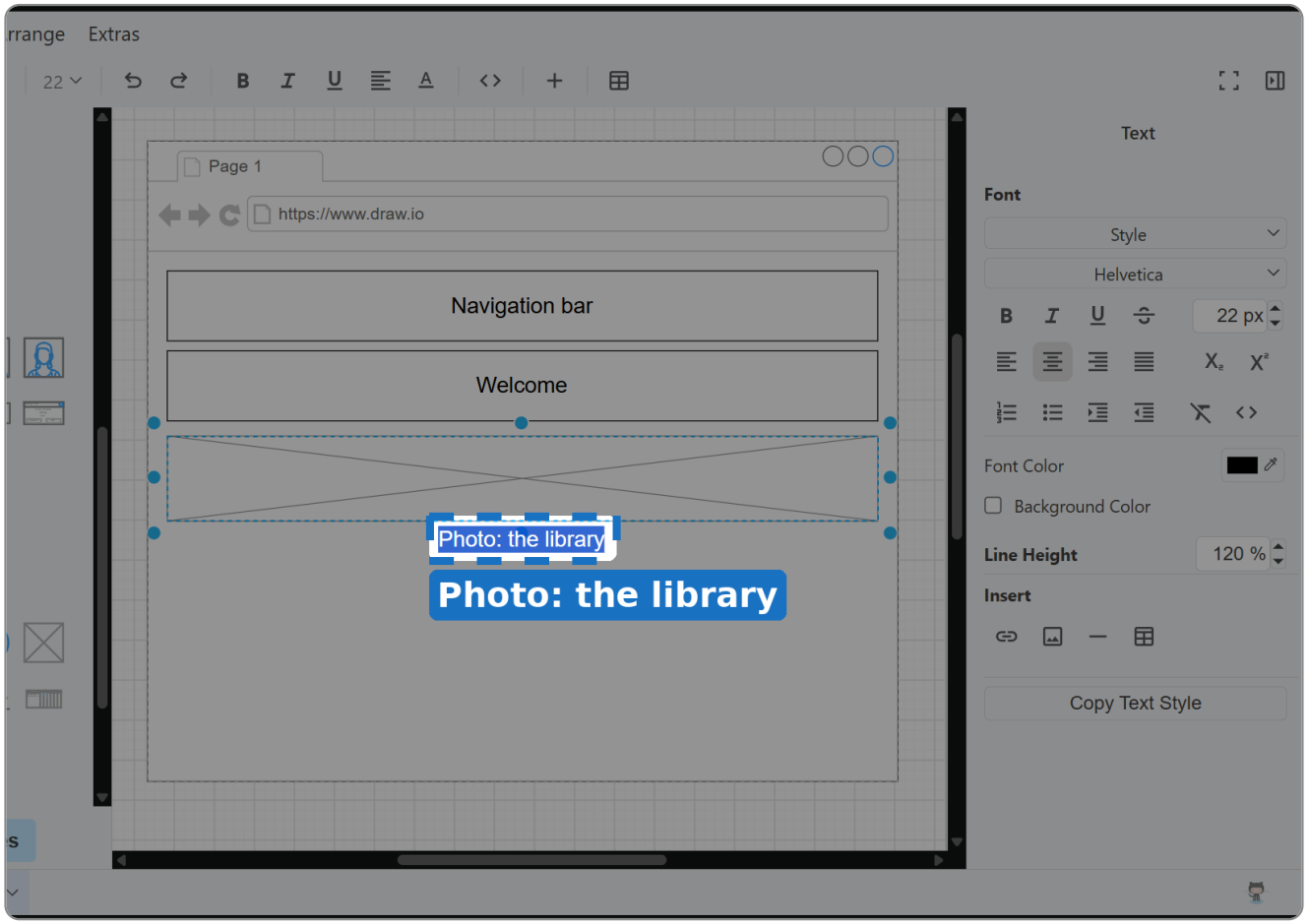
13

Draw.io › your page

Double-click the X box.

Type what the photo shows, like `Photo: the library`.

The words appear under the box.

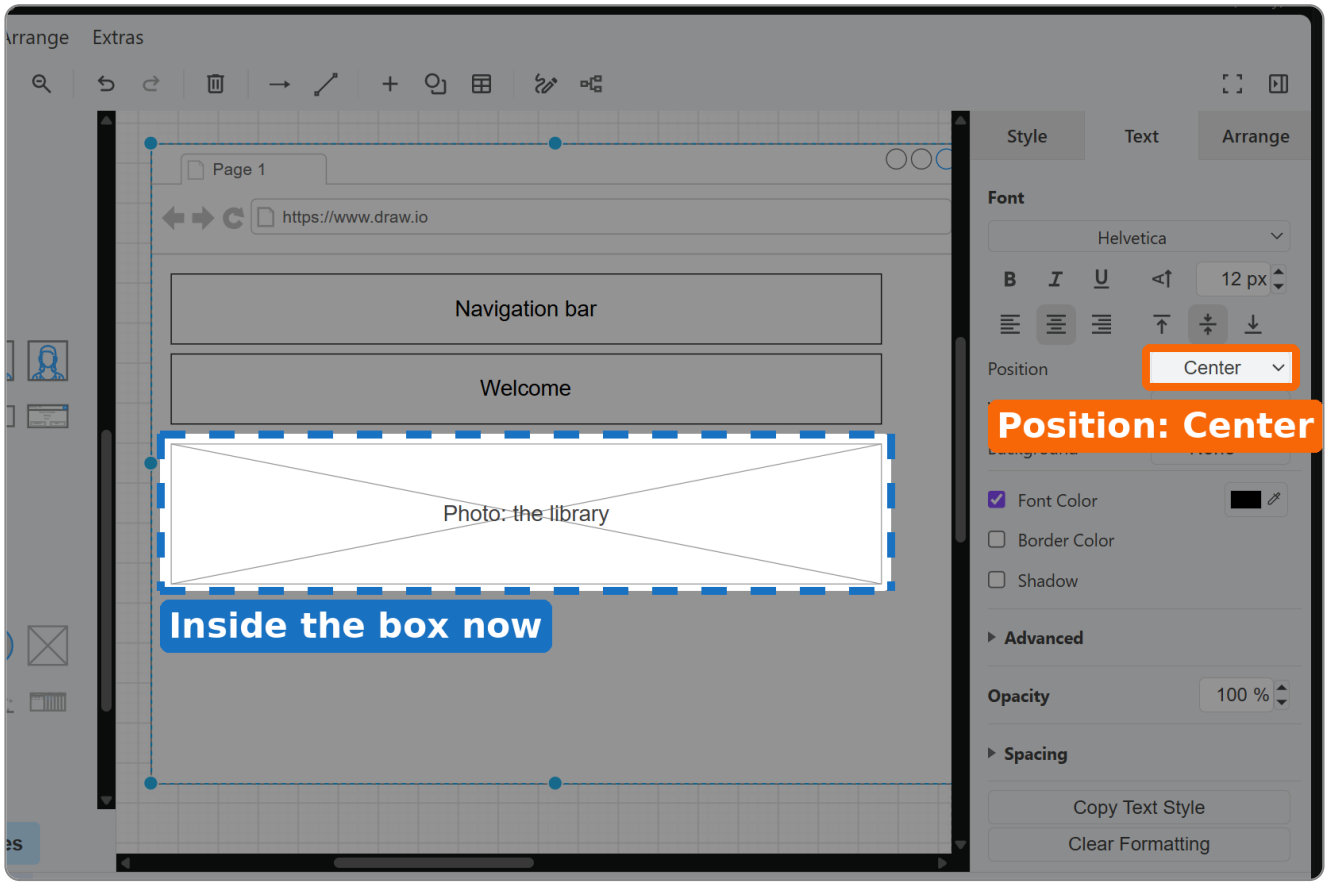


14

Draw.io › Text

In the **Text** tab, set **Position** to **Center**.

Now the words sit inside the box, like your other boxes.



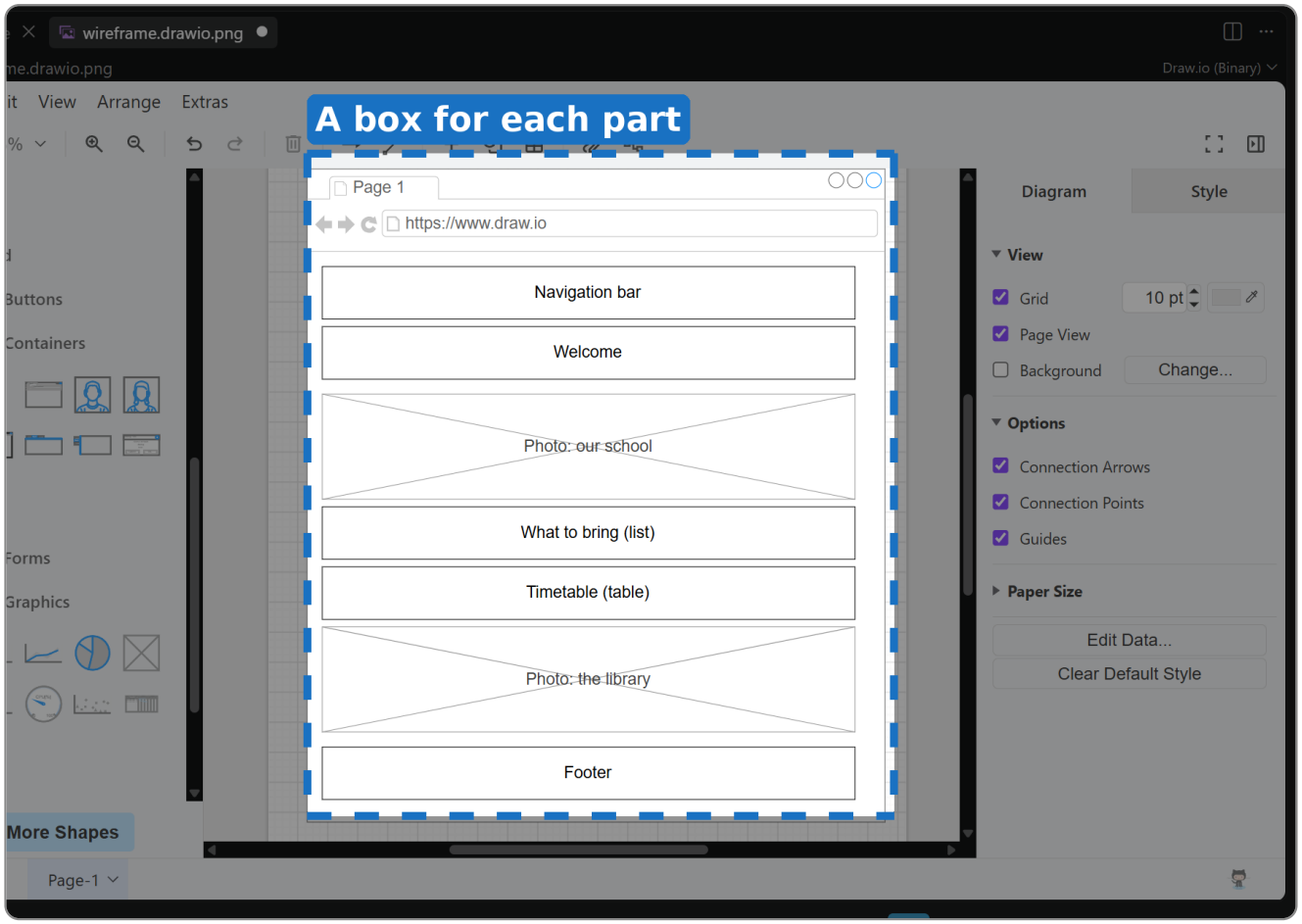
15

Draw.io › your page

Add a box for each part on your paper wireframe, such as a list, a table, more photos and a footer.

Drag boxes up or down to change the order.

Copy a box with Ctrl + D, then change its words.

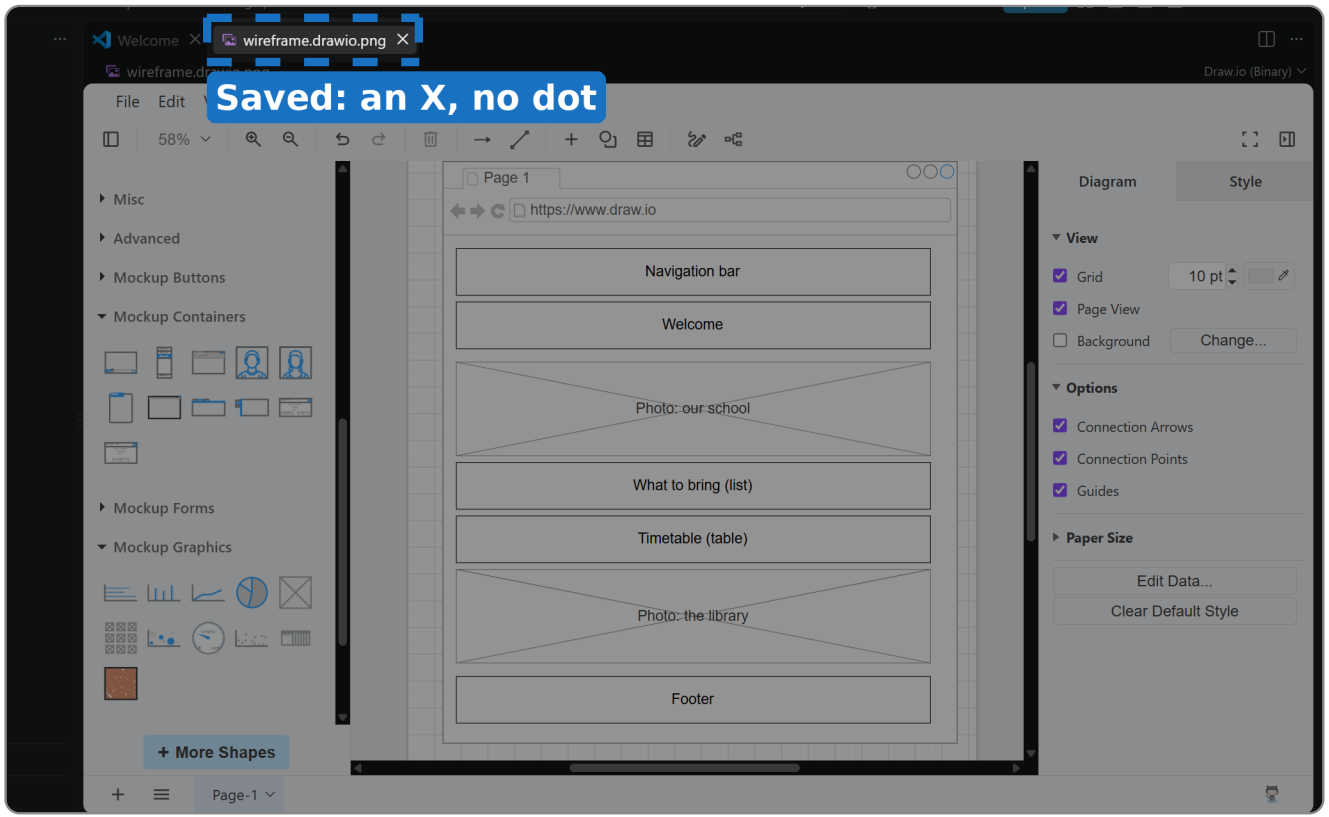


16

VS Code › wireframe.drawio.png

Press `Ctrl` + `S` to save.

> **Check:** an X on the tab, where the dot was.



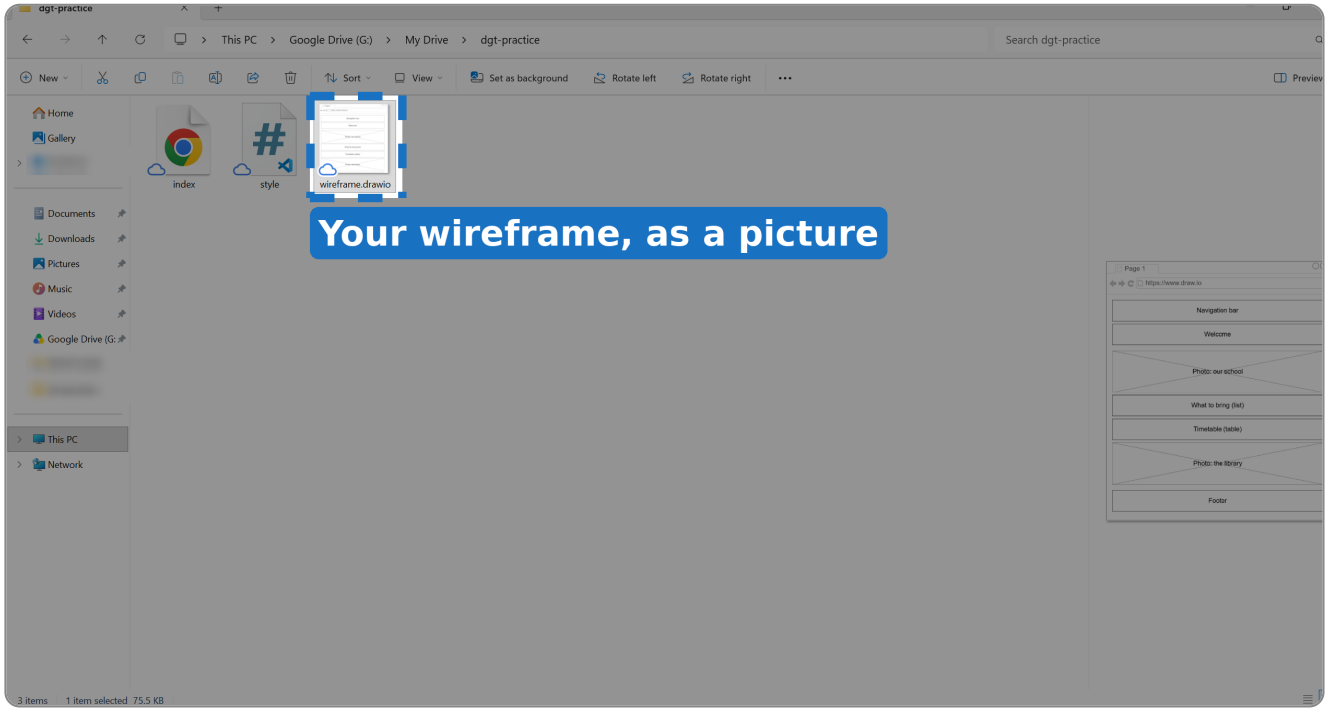
17

File Explorer › your project folder

Open your project folder in File Explorer.

Click **View** › **Large icons**.

> **Check:** your wireframe shows as a picture.



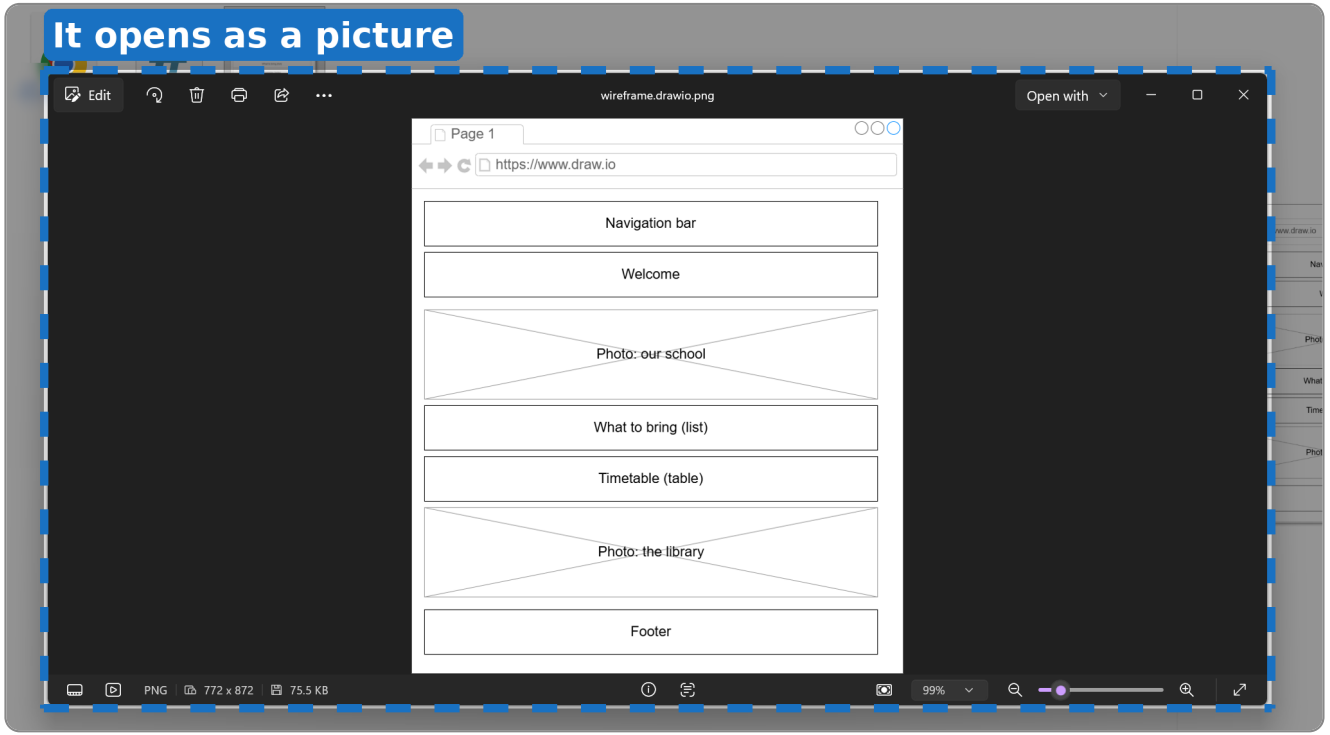
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Photos

Double-click `wireframe.drawio.png`.

Outside VS Code, it opens as an ordinary picture. That's the picture that goes in your template.

> **Check:** your wireframe in Photos.



Put it in your template

In your Google Doc, click **Insert** › **Image** › **Drive**, open your project folder and choose `wireframe.drawio.png`. Project in `Documents` › `GitHub`? Choose **Upload from computer** instead.

Change it later

Click the file in VS Code's Explorer: it opens in Draw.io again. Save, then put the new picture in your template, because the template keeps a copy.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I made `wireframe.drawio.png` in my project folder.
- [ ] My wireframe has a labelled box for each part, and an X box for each photo.
- [ ] My wireframe opens as a picture.